

THE
COMMUNICATIONS
AND ELECTRONICS BRANCH

95 CRAFTSMAN BOULEVARD
CFB KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4



BRANCHE
DES COMMUNICATIONS
ET DE L'ÉLECTRONIQUE

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BFC KINGSTON, ONTARIO, K7K 7B4

1000-5 (Br Adjt)

28 October 2021

Distribution List

SENATE MEETING:
RECORD OF DISCUSSION

RECORD OF ATTENDANCE

POSITION / APPOINTMENT	RANK & NAME
Chair / Colonel Commandant	Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Co-Chair / Branch Leader	Brigadier-General James Lambert
Member / Branch Advisor	Colonel John Roper
Member / Branch Chief	Chief Warrant Officer Gilles Philibert
Member / Association President	Major-General John Leech (Retired)
Member / Foundation President	Colonel Steve Sibbald (Retired)
Member / Incoming Col Cmdt	Brigadier-General Josée Robidoux (Retired)
Member / Serving Rep	Brigadier-General Patrice Sabourin
Member / Serving Rep	Brigadier-General Pascal Godbout
Member / Reserve Rep	Major Geoff Priems (incoming OC Museum)
Member / Retired Rep	Brigadier-General William 'Bill' Richard (Retired)
Member / Honorary Rep	Colonel Ken Lloyd
Member / CO Museum	Lieutenant-Colonel Bahir Ali
Guest / Unit Chief CFNOC	Chief Warrant Officer Alex Arndt
Secretariat / Branch Adjutant	Major Blair Christie

INTRODUCTORY REMARKS

- BGen (Ret'd) O'Keefe provided introductory remarks to the Senate.

REVIEW & APPROVAL OF PREVIOUS ROD

- Record of Discussion, dated 24 June 2021 APPROVED by the Senate.

NETHERLANDS 2022 UPDATE

- 40 x registered soldiers – payment initially due on 20 Oct 21. Travel advisory still in effect, Merit travel asked to delay down payment – \$38,950.00 – until **23 November 2021**.
- Final payment due on **29 January 2022**.
- All soldiers fully vaccinated.
- Testing of soldiers required prior to return to Canada (at \$100.00 per person – thus we need \$4,000.00 to incur this expense). MTF as this plan unfolds.
- 1st meeting via Zoom occurred on 26 October 2021 – Hugh Janseen / Dave Paterson reviewed key itinerary and events. Major Louis Lemaire updated ALCON on JIs / admin points (uniforms, leave, pay, etc.).
- Appreciation to Steve Sibbald (Project Charters to define arcs of fire for each Branch agency). Can be used as a template for future activities.

ACTION ITEM:

- **Major Christie:**
Deliver cheque (\$38,950.00) to Merit Travel contact on Tuesday, 23 November 2021.
- **Senate & Foundation:**
Prepare a cheque for the remainder, due Saturday, 29 January 2022.

HRH VISIT 2023 UPDATE

- Plan still in effect: HRH is visiting the 8th Hussars in Sussex, NB.
- LCol Jeff Nelson (CO 37 Signal Regiment) is our POC / liaison. He is co-ordinating Branch / Corps involvement with Col Hunter (8th Hussars).
- A small contingent from 37 Signal Regiment shall parade at the Royal Visit with representation from the Branch Leadership.
- Long weekend in May – time etched out just for the Branch to meet with HRH for a moment. MTF on DTG, approval, etc.

C&E FAMILY SURVEY

- *Bolted* the Branch Assessment onto the front-end of the Museum survey.
- 168 responses only.
- Some replies can form lessons learned: main message is that we – the Branch – suffer from poor communication and lack of awareness from our members (e.g. most surveyed responses confirm that they never heard of the Senate, BAC, or NCM Council, etc.).

BRANCH REPORT

- **Colonel Commandant:** BGen (Ret'd) Robidoux is officially in as of this writing.
- **Branch Advisor:** Colonel John Roper is the new C&E BA from ADM(Mat).
- **OC Branch Heritage & Tradition:** Major Priems expected to start in the 10-13 Dec 21 DTG. File is currently with DRSM (Director Reserve Service Management) for contract generation.
- **Branch HR Manager:** We've no *Chief Clerk*; this greatly impairs the Branch's ability to handle administrative affairs (event requests, travel, funds, TD, R&Q, etc.).

MUSEUM REPORT

- Approximately \$85,000 short for next year. Partnerships / K-Pass / Admission Fees must be on the table. These suggestions and options will be presented in greater detail in the upcoming BoD.
- The wage subsidy is ended as well.
- Mercury Ship may have a drop in revenue (Getting money to pay wages is difficult).
- Museum is suffering from major infrastructure issues: water leaks, mice, insects, HVAC.
- Less than 50% donate to P070 – directly results in lower foundation money to fund the museum operating costs.
- RCEME – installed exhibits did not take materials to fire marshal or curatorial staff, and thus they mistakenly covered all the fire alarms in the Annex. Fire alarms are being moved IOT align with new fire regulations. There will be a cost to this.
- RCEME – looking at their own museum as a potential CoA (Course of Action).
- SLA with C&E / RCCS and RCEME is up for renewal this year.
- Gun Vault – moisture problem resulting in rust. Grant from DHH for \$240,000.00 requested IOT maintain, display weaponry properly.
- Units not paying after ordering and receiving Kit Shop sends accoutrements.
- Gallery layout is 25 years old – a grant is required (upwards of \$500,000.00) with foundation support to update display cases, etc. all within proper distancing and fire regulations, etc.
- According to DHH – we are a national museum and must follow their protocols.

ACTION ITEMS:

- **Colonel Roper:**
Deep dive action plan with museum staff (as Chairman of the BoD) required to sort and prioritize financial issues impacting the museum (wages is the largest issue at this juncture).
- **Karen Young (via Lieutenant-Colonel Ali):**
BN by Karen owed to the BoD for an extraordinary BoD meeting on key museum action items, costs, and timetable IOT glean D&G. This BN and initial guidance is due in January 2022 and shall be furthered to the Branch Leader with priorities (e.g. wages, collection mgt, infra, display).
- **Lieutenant Grant (via Colonel Roper):**
BPT set-up a BoD Meeting on order for the Branch Advisor.

FOUNDATION REPORT

- New Foundation president (election to be held tomorrow – Friday, 29 October 2021).
- 3 x directors retiring leaving the Foundation with less than 10 on the roster (still require more serving members and more active service or retired NCMs).
- There are Gaps in the Branch Honor Roll / Book of Remembrance, the Foundation is devising CoA to mitigate
- Branch Senate decision is requested to be tabled:
 - 1st – honour roll plan from the Branch (do we undertake a complete re-write)
or do we *fill in the gaps*?
 - 2nd – what is the criteria for entry (e.g. died while serving, combat vets only, etc.)?

ASSOCIATION REPORT

- Main items are (1) heritage, (2) representation & advocacy, (3) admin, and (4) member services.
- *Jimmy Santa* planned again for this year in liaison with the Signallers' Club and Museum Staff (packing & shipping via Mercury Kit Shop).
- Concerns are (1) volunteers, (2) communications, and (3) financial prospects.

HONORARY APPOINTMENTS:

- We have an SOP / Aide Memoire for the Colonel Commandant
- We also have guidance files for the appointment of Branch / Corps Honorary Colonels replete with *arcs-of-fire* and roles
- The Branch Senate is advised out of professional courtesy; we – the Branch – acknowledge that the RCCS (CA) and RCAF chose their own honoraries.
- In keeping with this advisory spirit, CFIOG (thru IM Group staffing and endorsement processes) have staffed up nominees to the Minister of National Defence for their units:
 - CFS Leitrim – Dr. Dipak Roy
 - CFNOC – Ms. Rina Aristocrat
 - CFEWC – Colonel (Ret'd) Lennox John Leggat, CD, PhD

OPEN FORUM

- NSTR.

CLOSING REMARKS

- NSTR.


Brigadier-General Kevin O'Keefe (Retired)
Colonel Commandant

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JAMES 738
Date: 2021.11.01 15:52:22 -04'00'
Brigadier-General James Lambert
Branch Leader